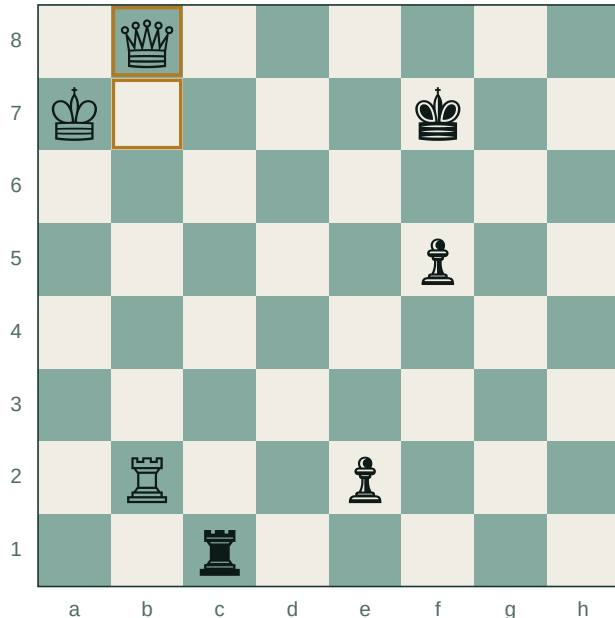


Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 56

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 56.b8=Q. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

56...Ra1+ 57. Kb6 e1=Q 58. Qc7+ Qe7 59. Qxe7+ Kxe7

56...Ra1+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **57.Kb6**.

57...e1=Q The pawn moves from e2 to e1. The pawn becomes a queen. Recorded reply: **58.Qc7+**.

58...Qe7 The queen moves from e1 to e7. Recorded reply: **59.Qxe7+**.

59...Kxe7 The king captures the queen on e7.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 6 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +8:** the balance goes from -7 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on a7. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.